Tiānfàng Chén [tʰjɛn⁵⁵.faŋ⁵¹ t͡ʂʰən³⁵]

tianfang.chen@ling-phil.ox.ac.uk
www.tianfangchen.com

Areas

Areas of specialization: Cognitive science, formal semantics and pragmatics, philosophy of language.
Areas of interest: Game and decision theory, multimodal semantics, epistemology, behavioral economics.

Education

Faculty of Linguistics, Philology and Phonetics, University of Oxford 2025 - 2027 *(expected)*
MPhil in Linguistics, Philology and Phonetics
Provisional thesis topic: *How Event Meaning Takes Shape* (Supervisor: Daniel Altshuler)

Department of Philosophy, Sun Yat-sen University 2021 - 2025
BPhil in Logic, Minor in Psychology GPA: 92 / 100, Ranking: 1 / 26
The Model and Experimental Study of Rational Speech Acts under Semantic Deviation (Supervisor: Liping Tang)

Publications

1. **Chen, T.**, Yao, Y., & Tang, L. (2026). Do Large Language Models Adapt Politeness Like Humans? In *Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, pp. 15412–15429.

Presentations

1. **Chen, T.**, & Tang, L. (2026, September 8 - 10). Modelling Linguistic Politeness in Cheap Talk [Oral]. *The 2026 Annual Meeting of the Linguistics Association of Great Britain (LAGB 2026)*, Edinburgh, UK.
2. **Chen, T.**, & Tang, L. (2026, July 22 - 25). Bounded Rationality Limits Pragmatic Optimization in Politeness [Poster]. *48th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2026)*, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.
3. **Chen, T.** (2026, July 22 - 25). Hearing Speech or Doing Inference? Diagnosing Speech Perception in Speech Large Language Models [Poster]. *48th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2026)*, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.
4. **Chen, T.** (2026, June 24 - 26). Public Signals Need Not Identify the Update Rule in Coordination [Oral]. *16th Conference on Logic and the Foundations of Game and Decision Theory (LOFT 16)*, London, UK.
5. **Chen, T.** (2026, June 22 - 23). Veridicality Alone Is Not Enough for Coordination [Oral]. *Oxford Postgraduate Conference in Linguistics 2026 (LingO 2026)*, Oxford, UK.
6. **Chen, T.** (2025, September 17 - 19). Communicating Under Different Meanings: Reflections from the Literal Listener [Poster]. *11th Experimental Pragmatics Conference (XPrag 2025)*, Cambridge, UK.

Professional Service

Linguistics Association of Great Britain Postgraduate Student Committee 2025.11 - Present
Treasurer (2026.01 - Present), previously Master's Student Liaison (2025.11 - 2026.01)
OUDiL 2026 reviewer; co-organizer of the 2026 Summer School; panellist for a Master's application session

Internships

Tencent Ethereal Audio Lab, Shenzhen, China 2025.02 - 2025.06
World Resources Institute, Beijing, China 2024.07 - 2025.01

Awards

Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis, Sun Yat-sen University 2025
China National Scholarship, Ministry of Education 2023, 2024
Academic Scholarship, Sun Yat-sen University 2022, 2023, 2024

Skills

Coding: Python, R, Stan, Java, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Git, PyTorch, WebPPL, memo.
Tools: jsPsych, OpenSesame, NAODAO, Prolific, LaTeX, SPSS, Praat.
Languages: Chinese (Mandarin, Hakka, Cantonese), English (TOEFL 110), Japanese (N1), French (CEFR B1).